Technical Delivery Specification Annex

Quillstone Post / Orrindale Partners co-produced series

Purpose. This annex is the operational delivery position for the first dual-territory package. It is written for business affairs, a broadcaster/streamer operations desk, and an external compliance reviewer. It does not certify a media file that was not supplied.

Contractual deliverable decision (authoritative). The US A/85 master is the contractual reference master for approval, archive, and change control. The European streamer receives a controlled R128 derivative made from that approved picture and source stems. The derivative is not a second creative approval and cannot replace the reference master. If the executed distribution agreement states a different hierarchy, Business Affairs must issue a written change notice before mastering.

1. Scope and jurisdiction map

Recipient / use	Governing delivery position	Status in this annex
US broadcaster (primary approval)	A/85 loudness regime: -24 LKFS programme target. True-peak and file-format values are recipient-manual items until confirmed.	Authoritative reference master; approval gate applies.
European streamer (controlled derivative)	R128 regime: -23 LUFS integrated target and -1 dBTP maximum true peak. Confirm any tolerance, channel layout, and platform-specific wrapper rules.	Derivative of approved reference; separate QC record.

Boundary. “Universal master” is retained only as a creative source concept. It is not a claim that one unspecified file simultaneously conforms to both loudness regimes. No programme-specific frame rate, language, caption list, duration, or measured value is assumed here.

2. Source legend

Code	Authority	How it is used
STD	Normative standard: ANSI/CTA-200 (A/85); EBU R 128 (R128).	Technical measurement or practice; applies only to the jurisdiction/version stated.
CON	Executed distribution agreement and recipient delivery manual.	Contractual requirement; confirm against signed schedule before release.
HOUSE	Quillstone Post internal control.	Workflow safeguard or evidence requirement; cannot override CON.

3. Changed assumptions and material impact

Previous draft assumption	Changed dual-territory requirement	Material consequence / annex response
One universal broadcast master would satisfy recipients.	US broadcaster and European streamer have different loudness regimes and acceptance workflows.	One authoritative A/85 reference plus controlled R128 derivative; each gets its own conformance record and delivery manifest.
“Broadcast standard” loudness treated as a single number.	A/85 points to -24 LKFS; R128 uses -23 LUFS and -1 dBTP.	Measure integrated programme loudness and true peak per version. Do not transpose results between versions.
Stems assumed to be a convenience export.	Stems can change summing, gating behaviour, and downstream re-versioning.	Require component stems to sum to the approved mix within documented alignment and gain policy; QC mix and stems together.
Recipient format and ancillary rules could be filled from habit.	No broadcaster/streamer manual or programme facts supplied.	Mark frame rate, raster, language, captions, wrapper, and metadata as confirmation-required; escalate rather than invent.

4. Technical delivery specification

Domain / check	Requirement and acceptance rule	Source
Picture essence	Container, codec, raster/scanning, cadence and frame rate must match the executed recipient schedule. Record exact values in the manifest; values are **TO BE CONFIRMED** here. Preserve cadence; no unapproved frame-rate conversion.	CON / HOUSE
Audio essence	PCM audio at 48 kHz; bit depth and channel count/layout per recipient schedule. Track map must name full mix, M&E;, dialogue, music and effects where supplied; do not create absent stems.	STD practice / CON
US loudness	Reference master: integrated programme loudness target **-24 LKFS** under A/85 measurement practice. Record meter, gate setting and true-peak result. Tolerance, if any, is CON and must be stated.	STD: A/85
European loudness	Controlled derivative: integrated programme loudness target **-23 LUFS** per R128, with **-1 dBTP maximum** true peak. Apply R128 gating and document measurement window; do not claim A/85 conformance from this result.	STD: R128 §2, §3
Dialogue / gating	Use integrated programme measurement. Where a recipient requests speech-gated or dialogue-anchored review, run that view as a supplemental check and label it; it does not silently replace the governing integrated method.	STD: R128 / CON
Stems and summing	Export named stems with identical start, sample rate, bit depth and channel order. Recombination must reproduce the approved full mix under the stated gain/pan policy; any exception is logged and approved.	HOUSE / CON
Timing / sync	Programme start timecode, drop/non-drop basis, first frame, black, tail and duration are confirmation-required. Picture, mix, captions and metadata must share the same start and duration; verify by spot-check and manifest comparison.	CON / HOUSE

4. Technical delivery specification (continued)

Domain / check	Requirement and acceptance rule	Source
Captions / subtitles	Supply only languages and formats listed in the executed schedule. Caption files must align to the same programme start, cadence and duration; ownership for authoring/translation is CON and must be recorded in the manifest.	CON / HOUSE
Accessibility	Audio description, accessibility mix, forced narrative and related files are “required only if scheduled.” Record owner and acceptance status; absence is an open issue, not a presumed waiver.	CON
Metadata / wrapper	Manifest records title/episode identifiers supplied by Orrindale, version, territory, audio layout, caption inventory, checksum and delivery date. Filename and wrapper rules remain TO BE CONFIRMED against recipient manual.	CON / HOUSE
Package integrity	Deliver a manifest, checksums, QC report and approval record with each file. Verify checksum after transfer and retain immutable delivery evidence.	HOUSE
Color / legal text	Check legal slates, ratings, logos, music cue or rights notes only against approved source/rights instructions. Technical QC cannot cure a rights hold.	CON / HOUSE

5. Coordinated QC method

Loudness, true peak, gating and stems are one decision set. Re-rendering or gain changes to meet a loudness target can alter true peak; stem recombination can alter both loudness and gating. Therefore QC is rerun on the exact deliverable file after every audio change.

Sequence	Operational check	Evidence / decision
1	Verify file identity, start, cadence, channels and stem alignment.	Manifest + waveform/spot-check; FAIL blocks measurement.
2	Measure integrated loudness with the governing regime (A/85 for reference; R128 for derivative), including stated gate/window.	Meter export with target, actual value, meter/tool version and operator.
3	Measure true peak on the same render; confirm R128 derivative does not exceed -1 dBTP.	Peak report; any remediation triggers repeat of steps 2-4.
4	Recombine supplied stems and compare against approved full mix; inspect dialogue intelligibility and mute/solo integrity.	Stem-sum check and exception note if policy differs.
5	Run captions, metadata, checksum and package checks after picture/audio lock.	Final QC report and manifest signed by QC owner.

Acceptance logic: PASS = all applicable checks evidenced; FAIL = release blocked; WAIVER = written CON approval naming scope and expiry; UNRESOLVED = confirmation or measurement outstanding, release blocked unless Business Affairs authorizes a documented hold.

6. Reference-master conformance record

Record ID: QP-REF-001 **Reference master ID:** QP_SERIES_REF_v001 (identifier assigned for this review; media not supplied) **Review state:** OPEN / NOT MEASURED

This is a controlled record template for one reference master. “Pending” and “TO BE CONFIRMED” are deliberate statuses; no measurement or programme fact is asserted.

Check / provision	Applicable version	Status	Evidence required / disposition
File identity, checksum, wrapper	Reference + derivative	**Pending**	Manifest, checksum after transfer; FAIL blocks release.
Frame rate, raster, scan, cadence	Recipient-specific	**TO BE CONFIRMED**	Signed recipient schedule; do not select a value by habit.
Integrated loudness	A/85 reference: -24 LKFS; R128 derivative: -23 LUFS	**Not measured**	Meter export on exact file; record gate/window and actual value.
True peak	R128 derivative: <= -1 dBTP; reference per CON	**Not measured**	True-peak report; if fail, remediate and repeat loudness + peak.
Dialogue-gated supplemental view	Only if CON requests	**Pending**	Label as supplemental; never substitute for integrated target.
Stem map and sum	Reference + derivative	**Pending**	Track map, alignment check, recombination comparison; log exception.
Sync, duration, black/tail	Recipient-specific	**TO BE CONFIRMED**	Timecode and spot-check report; align picture/audio/captions/metadata.
Captions, accessibility, metadata	Only if scheduled	**Pending**	Inventory and owner from CON; absence remains open.
Approval / rights / package	Distribution agreement	**Pending**	Business Affairs approval, rights confirmation, manifest and checksum.

Record sign-off fields

Role	Named person / date	Decision
Mastering technician	_____	Prepared / corrections logged
QC lead	_____	PASS / FAIL / WAIVER / UNRESOLVED
Business Affairs / approver	_____	Release authorized / blocked

7. Provision-to-source traceability matrix

ID	Provision (operative rule)	Basis	Owner / evidence
T01	A/85 reference target -24 LKFS integrated.	STD A/85	Mastering + meter export
T02	R128 derivative target -23 LUFS integrated; max -1 dBTP.	STD R128 §§2-3	Mastering + peak report
T03	Gate/window recorded; dialogue-gated view supplemental only.	STD R128 / CON	QC lead + meter settings
T04	Stem components recombine to approved mix under stated policy.	HOUSE	Audio QC + stem-sum evidence
T05	Frame/raster/cadence/sample/bit/channel values confirmed to schedule.	CON	Business Affairs + manifest
T06	Picture, audio, captions, metadata share start/duration; timecode recorded.	CON / HOUSE	QC spot-check + manifest
T07	Ancillary languages/accessibility supplied only when scheduled; owner recorded.	CON	Delivery coordinator
T08	Checksum, manifest, QC report and approval retained.	HOUSE	Delivery coordinator + archive
T09	No release with unresolved technical or contractual facts.	HOUSE / CON	Approver disposition
T10	Safety/legal hold is a narrow replacement workflow, not a QC shortcut.	HOUSE / CON	Authorized incident record

8. Roles, approvals and release gates

Role	Accountability
Senior post-production technician	Mastering plan, version naming, technical remediation and archive handoff.
QC lead	Independent measurement, stem/sync/package checks, status and evidence completeness.
Business Affairs / distribution lead	Confirms recipient schedules and rights; authorizes waivers, contractual changes and release.
Delivery coordinator	Manifest, transfer, checksum, receipt and withdrawal notifications.

Release gates: (G1) technical QC PASS for exact file; (G2) source/rights and captions/accessibility status confirmed; (G3) named approval or written waiver; (G4) manifest/checksum/package integrity verified; (G5) delivery receipt and immutable record stored. Any failed or unresolved gate blocks release.

9. Safety or legal hold exception (rare, severe, controlled)

This procedure applies only where release of the approved package could create a credible safety risk or legal exposure (for example, a formally reported rights injunction or dangerous factual error). It is not a route around ordinary creative disagreement, late notes, or a failed meter check.

Control	Required action
Identify	Log incident ID, reason, affected territory/version, reporter, timestamp and evidence. Mark the affected package **WITHDRAWN / HOLD** in the manifest and delivery tracker.
Authorize	Business Affairs or designated legal/safety authority gives written authorization naming scope, expiry/review time and whether a replacement may be built. Technician cannot self-authorize.
Version	Create a new immutable version ID (for example, QP_SERIES_US_v002-HOLDFIX). Preserve the held file, hashes and prior approval; never overwrite.
Re-QC	Re-run full applicable QC: picture/audio, integrated loudness, true peak, gating view, stems, sync, captions, metadata, checksum and package checks. A changed audio parameter requires coordinated loudness/peak/stem review.
Notify / withdraw	Delivery coordinator sends controlled withdrawal or replacement notice to every recipient that received or queued the held version. Record acknowledgement; block automated redelivery until cleared.
Release / close	Approver signs replacement release or extends hold. Close only when risk owner confirms disposition and the incident, evidence, notifications and final hashes are archived.

10. Open confirmations before signature

The following are intentionally unresolved because no recipient manual, executed schedule, or media source was supplied: exact container/codec/raster and cadence; programme start, duration, black and tail; channel layout and stem inventory; caption/subtitle languages and formats; accessibility assets; filename/wrapper and metadata fields; loudness tolerances; and actual measurements. Business Affairs owns escalation to the recipient and must attach the confirmed schedule to the release record.

Document control

Field	Value
Document	Quillstone Delivery Specification Annex + Conformance Record
Version / state	v1.0 / controlled draft for agreement review
Effective trigger	Executed distribution agreement and recipient schedules; until then, confirmation-required fields remain release-blocking.
Record retention	Manifest, hashes, meter exports, QC report, approvals, waivers and notifications retained with the master package.

End of annex